

“Fantastic!” the producer said when he heard the mash. “When can I book you?” He assumed Trevor was a 20-something DJ looking for a gig!

Trevor started getting FedEx packages from Atlanta full of hats, shirts and jackets. “I’m going to sponsor you, and this is how we brand you,” the producer told him. “I want you to start taking images and videos of yourself wearing these clothes.” That’s when I called Daymond John from *Shark Tank*. Daymond’s very involved in music and knows his stuff.

“Is this guy for real?” I asked.

“He’s legit, Kevin,” Daymond reassured me. “He’s a major player—he works with all the big DJs around the world. But your son’s 15. Once you plunge him into this culture, there’s no turning back.”

Linda and I discussed it. On one hand, Trevor had an opportunity to monetize his interest, to learn about entrepreneurship, and maybe even launch a lucrative career and make some serious money. On the other, he was still just a kid! Club culture is fueled by alcohol and illicit drugs, and my wife and I don’t endorse that lifestyle. The producer hinted that if Trevor’s career took off, he’d have to quit school, and neither Linda nor I was up for that. “Absolutely not,” she said. “He’s going to finish school, and he can do this as a hobby.”

So the three of us came to a mutual decision: we said no to the guy from Atlanta. Meanwhile, Trevor and I released a few more tracks on Twitter. Club owners around Toronto started calling him up, offering to pay him to do gigs. We established some ground rules. Trevor could take the DJ gigs under two conditions: never on a school night, and only if it didn’t interfere with his homework. He agreed. But before he could start spinning locally, he needed some equipment. You’ve got to bring your own laptop and something called a tracker system to the club, and it’s not cheap, I learned—a tracker system alone costs around \$1,000. When Trevor asked if he could borrow \$1,000 to make the purchase, I said, “Nope. You’re going to have to use your own money.” He was less than thrilled with this response.